

The Washington Post

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 **Partly sunny 62/44** • Tomorrow: Partly sunny 62/46 **B18** *Democracy Dies in Darkness* **FRIDAY, OCTOBER 24, 2025 • \$4**

NBA coach, player are arrested in FBI probes

Billups, Rozier face charges in sports-betting, illegal poker cases

BY RICK MAESE
AND JEREMY ROEBUCK

Long-simmering fears over America's sports-betting boom erupted into scandal Thursday morning as FBI agents arrested two high-profile NBA figures, including Hall of Fame guard and Portland Trail Blazers Coach Chauncey Billups, who authorities said was involved in a mob-run rigged poker scheme and supplied information to sports bettors about his team.

Billups was arrested in Portland, Oregon, just hours after his Trail Blazers team lost its season-opening game Wednesday night. He was charged with money laundering and wire fraud conspiracy over his alleged participation in rigged poker games that also involved members of Mafia crime families, also called La Cosa Nostra.

Agents also arrested Miami Heat player Terry Rozier, a former first-round draft pick, in Orlando. Authorities allege he participated in a sports betting operation that involved sharing information with bettors that wasn't publicly available. He was charged with

SEE NBA ON A15

Jerry Brewer: Betting scandals continue to poison our trust. **B7**

Democrats plan to draw new Va. map in their favor

Reworked congressional districts would counter GOP efforts elsewhere

BY TEO ARMUS,
ERIN COX,
GREGORY S. SCHNEIDER
AND MAEGAN VAZQUEZ

Virginia Democrats are initiating a plan to redraw the state's congressional map in their favor to counter efforts to boost Republicans in other states, a push that state lawmakers will begin discussing in a special session on Monday.

Lawmakers took the first step Thursday by calling to reconvene both chambers of the General Assembly, which Democrats control, for a special session to consider redistricting. The process also involves clearing several hurdles, including passing a measure to advance the plan before upcoming statewide elections on Nov. 4, keeping control of the statehouse in those elections, and eventually winning the support of voters in a ballot referendum.

President Donald Trump has initiated a multistate redistricting arms race in hopes of keeping his party's narrow hold on the U.S. House. States normally redistrict once a decade, after the census is taken.

Virginia Democrats' push to include redistricting in a special session comes less than two weeks

SEE REDISTRICTING ON A5

In Indiana: Republicans lack the votes for new map Trump wants. **A4**

The East Wing is now only a memory



JACQUELYN MARTIN/AP

Construction workers atop the Treasury Department, bottom right, watch the White House East Wing's continuing demolition Thursday.

DAMAGE CONTROL AFTER DEMOLITION

Trump defends project amid intense backlash

BY JONATHAN EDWARDS,
DAN DIAMOND
AND OLIVIA GEORGE

The East Wing of the White House is gone.

Wrecking crews had completely removed the decades-old annex by midday Thursday, just three days after they started, to make way for a pet project of President Donald Trump: a 90,000-square-foot ballroom. The teardown, which The Washington Post first reported Monday, prompted a massive backlash from historic preservationists and Democrats, who accused Trump of destroying a national landmark and doing so under a cloak of secrecy.

The work also drew thousands of tourists to Pennsylvania Avenue this week to watch — or rather listen to — the heavy machinery. The Trump administration has restricted the public from most vantage points, ordering employees of the adjacent Treasury Department not to share photos and escorting away

SEE WHITE HOUSE ON A5

Philip Kennicott: A teardown to build the president's image. **B1**

New oil sanctions are 'serious,' Putin says, but won't stop war

BY ROBYN DIXON,
ELLEN FRANCIS,
CATHERINE BELTON
AND LIZZIE JOHNSON

Russian President Vladimir Putin on Thursday rejected U.S. pressure on Moscow to halt its war in Ukraine, saying he would not be swayed by President Donald Trump's decision to cancel a

planned summit in Budapest and slap what Trump called "tremendous sanctions" on two of Russia's largest oil companies.

While Russia's economy braces for the sanctions, Putin dismissed them as futile and warned that the "unfriendly act toward Russia" was damaging relations between the countries just as they had begun to recover.

"The new U.S. sanctions are an attempt to put pressure on Russia," Putin told Russian reporters Thursday evening. "No self-respecting country ever does anything under pressure. Russia is a self-respecting country."

The sanctions, which cut off Russian oil giants Rosneft and Lukoil from American banking systems, essentially blocking

them from operating in U.S. dollars, are "serious for us and will have certain consequences," Putin said. "But they will not significantly impact our economic well-being."

He also downplayed Trump's decision to shelve the Budapest talks. He said they've been postponed, not canceled.

"It would be a mistake to ap-

proach the summit in Budapest without preparation," Putin said. "Dialogue is always better than any confrontation, than any disputes, and especially than war." It was Putin who ordered Russia's full-scale invasion of Ukraine in 2022.

He said the meeting was proposed by the U.S. side. The door

SEE RUSSIA ON A12



NOAH BERGER/AP

Trump calls off 'surge' in San Francisco

Protesters block a Customs and Border Protection caravan in California on Thursday. After talking with San Francisco's mayor and "friends" — including Salesforce's and Nvidia's CEOs — the president said he would not send federal personnel to fight crime in the city. **Story, A3**

Obama lends his cachet to redistricting fight

BY YASMEEN ABUTALEB
AND LIZ GOODWIN

In late July, Barack Obama spoke with his former attorney general, Eric Holder, about how Democrats should respond to President Donald Trump's unprecedented mid-decade push to add five favorable U.S. House seats to protect the Republican majority. They had each spent days conflicted about what to do.

Both had previously championed nonpartisan redistricting. But they agreed that letting Trump's effort in Texas go unanswered wasn't an option. They kept coming back to a plan from California Gov. Gavin Newsom (D) that would offset the move with five new Democratic-leaning seats. Within days, Holder drafted a statement endorsing the proposal and ran it by the former president, who quickly signed off.

It marked a stark shift that, in their view, was a sign of the emergency measures they believed were required.

"We're doing things that kind of go against what we talked about," Holder said. But they decided, "we have to preserve our democracy if ultimately we're going to heal it."

That phone call set in motion an urgent behind-the-scenes effort by the former president to

SEE OBAMA ON A4

U.S. Anglican Church leader accused of sexual misconduct

Unwanted advance, cash payments, other claims roil denomination

BY IAN SHAPIRA

The Anglican Church in North America — forged from the headline-grabbing conservative revolt against the Episcopal Church's first openly gay bishop — is now confronting allegations by clergy and parishioners against two of its top leaders: One is accused of sexual misconduct, while the other allegedly abused his power by allowing men with troubling histories into the church.

The denomination's senior-most official, Archbishop Stephen Wood, 62, has been accused by a former children's ministry director of putting his hand against the back of her head and trying to kiss her in his office in April 2024. The incident allegedly occurred two months before he was elected to the helm, according to a new church presentment, which The Washington Post obtained in advance of its Monday submission.

The woman, who gave an interview to The Post, also accused Wood of giving her thousands of dollars in unexpected payments from church coffers before the alleged advance. Wood, a married father of four sons, remains the rector of St. Andrew's Church in the Charleston, South Carolina, area, and a bishop overseeing

a diocese of more than 40 churches across the South.

If the presentment triggers an ecclesiastical trial, Wood could be defrocked and forced to step down. He is the first archbishop in the Anglican Church in North America to face a presentment, a denomination spokeswoman said.

Wood declined to answer specific questions about the accusations in the presentment.

"I do not believe these allegations have any merit," Wood said in a statement. "I place my faith and trust in the process outlined in our canons to bring clarity and truth in these matters and respectfully decline to comment further at this time."

Wednesday morning, the senior warden of St. Andrew's Church informed congregants of the complaint against Wood and alerted them to The Post's reporting. "This is a painful and very personal process for all involved," wrote Mike Hughes, the church's senior warden, in an email.

The presentment — a report that chronicles formal allegations of canonical offenses — is unfolding amid a protracted ecclesiastical trial against another leader, Stewart Ruch III, an Anglican bishop who oversees a diocese of 18 churches in the

SEE ARCHBISHOP ON A6



Stephen Wood

IN THE NEWS

Alaska road The Trump administration said it is moving forward with a controversial deal that allows construction through a refuge. **A18**

Trump pardons Binance founder Changpeng Zhao, who pleaded guilty to enabling money laundering in 2023, stepped down as CEO under a settlement with DOJ. **A13**

THE NATION **Lawmakers** voiced little hope of an extension of health insurance subsidies by Nov. 1. **A2** **In New York's** mayoral race, Zohran Mamdani called attacks by Andrew M. Cuomo "racist." **A8**

THE WORLD **King Charles III** prayed with Pope Leo XIV, a moment 500 years in the making. **A9** **Israel must free** a U.S. teen it has held since February, his family and lawmakers say. **A10**

THE ECONOMY **Major** social media platforms do not use a tech industry standard touted as a way to flag fake content, tests using AI videos found. **A13** **Gen Z** employees are largely rejecting the frenetic workplace culture in favor of work-life boundaries. **A14**

STYLE **At an annual** regatta in Oregon, participants raced in costumes and paddled giant, hollowed-out pumpkins. **B1**

SPORTS **Wizards rookie** Tre Johnson made a strong first impression by scoring 16 points coming off the bench. **B7**

THE REGION **A Maryland woman** sent her husband AI photos of an intruder as a joke, but the prank escalated, leading to her arrest. **B13**

WEEKEND **This Springsteen** rock-and-roll biopic doesn't live up to the album that inspired it.

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